

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, mostly sunny, warmer, high 82. **Tonight**, clear, near-average temperatures, light winds, low 61. **Tomorrow**, sunshine and clouds, high 86. Weather map, Page B12.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



The aftermath of a Russian strike on a residential building in Kyiv, Ukraine, on Tuesday. Moscow had warned of an attack for days.

Trump Seeks To Tie Grants To His Agenda

By TONY ROMM

WASHINGTON — The White House is seeking to exert more control over billions of dollars in annual government grants, aiming to restrict a vast swath of funding — in health, housing, science and transportation — so it primarily serves the purposes and organizations politically aligned with President Trump.

While the administration says that its primary goal is to safeguard taxpayer money, its proposal amounts to a major escalation in its attempt to reimagine the nation's spending, even as Congress and the courts continue to rebuke the president for abusing such powers.

Mr. Trump's ambitions were made clear in a roughly 400-page blueprint that was released to little fanfare on Friday. If completed, it would require all federal grants to be approved by the president's political appointees, who must ensure that the money would “demonstrably advance the president's policy priorities.”

For the agencies that issue those awards and the nonprofit groups, local governments, universities and other entities that receive the money, the Trump administration would also impose a set of highly prescriptive and political criteria.

The government could not issue grants to projects or groups that “deny the biological reality of sex or the sex binary in humans,” for example. Nor could it seek to fund initiatives that “promote anti-American values,” contribute to illegal immigration, advance diversity, equity and inclusion, or assist in voter registration.

The rules would further limit the ability of grant recipients to engage in some “issue advocacy.” Those that are funded would be scrutinized for their compliance with “religious liberty laws” and their “memberships and affiliations” with outside groups. And they could face the outright termination of their grants if the Trump administration someday determines that their actions are not in the “public interest.”

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Primaries in Six States
Coverage of races for California governor and Los Angeles mayor, as well as key contests in a handful of states, is at nytimes.com.

Deadly Russian Attack on Kyiv Comes With Psychological Toll

By MARIA VARENIKOVA and KIM BARKER

KYIV, Ukraine — More than a week after Russia warned of an attack on Kyiv that would be so big that diplomats and other foreigners should flee, Moscow finally struck early on Tuesday. Its forces launched hundreds of drones and dozens of missiles at the capital and other cities in Ukraine, killing at least 22 people, the Ukrainian authorities said.

The bombardment of Kyiv was similar in scale to two other deadly attacks last month. Moscow has continued its air campaign against the capital even as the Russian military has suffered its worst period in years on the front line, measured in territory gained.

What appeared to be different

about the latest assault on Kyiv was the psychological element. Last month, Russia's foreign ministry issued dire warnings of retaliation for what Russian officials said was a Ukrainian drone attack that struck a college dormitory in the Russian-controlled Luhansk region of eastern Ukraine, killing 21 students. The toll could not be independently verified.

After Russia threatened another huge strike on Kyiv, including on “decision-making centers,” and told foreigners to evacuate, Western envoys rallied around the Ukrainian government, saying they would stay put and not give in to intimidation tactics.

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Jalen Brunson of the Knicks and Victor Wembanyama of the Spurs lead their teams into a best-of-seven championship series that begins Wednesday in San Antonio.

SPECIAL SECTION

Payout Fund Off the Table, Blanche Says

By GLENN THRUSH and ALAN FEUER

WASHINGTON — Todd Blanche, the acting attorney general, said on Tuesday he was withdrawing a proposal to create a \$1.8 billion fund to compensate people claiming to be victims of unfair prosecution, amid a revolt among Republicans who saw it as an ethical and political disaster.

“We're not moving forward with the fund, period,” Mr. Blanche told members of a House Appropriations subcommittee. He repeated himself to make clear that he meant the fund proposal would be permanently withdrawn.

His statement could break an impasse with Senate Republicans, who had demanded the fund be scrapped as a precondition for passing a major immigration enforcement bill. Opponents had described the proposal as a slush fund for allies of President Trump.

But Mr. Blanche said he would leave in place an order he signed last month that would, in effect, block the I.R.S. from investigating Mr. Trump, his family and his

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In an Inviting Park, Obama’s Forbidding Tower

CHICAGO — The Obama Presidential Center has dropped on Chicago's South Side. Its signature building is a blocky, granite-clad museum tower that the former president wanted to look like four upraised hands. Maybe it's me

but I don't see it. I see a boulder in a park. The center arrives after years of planning, \$850 million in private fund-raising, spasms of community blowback, and eye-rolling about the glamorous, brooding, unapologetic 225-foot-tall “Obamalisk.”

The architecture is certainly ambitious and formidable. The center is built for the ages to celebrate the nation's first Black president.

It's also the tallest monument yet to presidential self-glorification, although the current occupant of the Oval Office is content-

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Housing Official Chosen To Lead U.S. Intelligence

A Trump Loyalist With No Known Security Background Will Oversee Agencies

This article is by **Maggie Haberman, Julian E. Barnes and Matthew Goldstein.**

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Tuesday named Bill Pulte, who has pressed for investigations into the president's foes, to serve as the acting director of national intelligence, giving him oversight of U.S. intelligence agencies.

He will replace Tulsi Gabbard, who announced last month that she was stepping down to care for her husband, who has cancer.

Mr. Pulte, who leads the federal housing finance agency, has no known background in intelligence, defense or national security, but he has been among the most aggressive advocates for prosecuting Democrats and others perceived by Mr. Trump as having crossed him.

The director of national intelligence is a cabinet post that oversees 18 intelligence agencies and supervises the production of the President's Daily Brief, the compendium of intelligence analysis viewed by senior policymakers.

The appointment was viewed with deep skepticism on Capitol Hill. Democrats immediately denounced it, saying that Mr. Pulte did not have the national security experience the law creating the office required. Multiple senior Republicans also voiced doubts.

“We don't need a weaponized D.N.I.,” Senator John Thune of South Dakota, the majority leader, told reporters. “We need profes-

sionals there.” Mr. Thune added: “If he's somebody we want in that position permanently, he's got a lengthy road ahead of him.”

For now, Mr. Trump seems intent on avoiding the confirmation process, naming Mr. Pulte to the national intelligence post on an acting basis. Mr. Pulte will continue to run the housing agency while taking on the new position, which he wanted and lobbied for, according to U.S. officials.

The Federal Vacancies Reform Act generally limits acting officials to a base line of 210 days. When Richard Grenell was the acting director of national intelligence in the first Trump administration, he served for 96 days.

Mr. Trump started calling allies about the appointment over the weekend, but the announcement surprised many senior officials at the Office of the Director of National Intelligence. Mr. Pulte did not respond to a message seeking comment.

On paper, the director of national intelligence, a role created after the Sept. 11 terrorist attacks, is among the most powerful cabinet positions, responsible for coordinating the work of the C.I.A. and a host of other agencies. But Mr. Trump has never seen it as an important role, his advisers have said. And in his first term, he believed staff members working for the office were leaking information about him.

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Doctors Seeing Grim Illnesses Strike Unvaccinated Children

By MAGGIE ASTOR and DANI BLUM

Doctors around the country say they are seeing more cases of serious, sometimes life-threatening illnesses that vaccines have long kept at bay, including whooping cough and bacterial infections that can cause pneumonia or meningitis.

The concern among doctors comes on the heels of a resurgence of measles nationwide, fueled by distrust in vaccines that grew during the Covid-19 pandemic, and that Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. and President Trump have amplified. Public health experts have long seen measles as a harbinger: Because it is so exceptionally contagious, it can be the first disease to spike as

vaccination rates broadly decline, and a sign of more to come.

For some of these diseases, national data show clear and substantial increases in recent years; for others, the increases are small, or there are anecdotal indications from doctors on the ground of increases that public statistics don't currently confirm.

While most children recover, these diseases aren't benign. Many children endure extended hospitalizations. Some infections can be fatal.

Dr. Meghan Hofto, a pediatric hospitalist at the University of Alabama at Birmingham, is one of the doctors who said she is seeing

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The Obama Presidential Center's 225-foot museum in Chicago.

FOOD D1-8

20 Wines, All Under \$20

Prices on most things keep rising, but there is still no need to break the bank for a delicious bottle of wine. PAGE D1

Some Wrinkles Yet Ahead

Once the purview of specialty shops and health food co-ops, date-based snacks are now a supermarket favorite. PAGE D8



INTERNATIONAL A4-11

Separatist Vote in Alberta

The oil-rich Western Canadian province is hurtling toward a referendum on remaining a part of Canada. PAGE A4

Race to Find Ebola Vaccine

The Bundibugyo virus, at the center of a rapidly widening epidemic in Africa, has no current treatment. PAGE A8

OBITUARIES B10-11

Hall of Fame N.F.L. Receiver

Raymond Berry was quarterback Johnny Unitas's secret weapon with flypaper hands who rose to big occasions. He was 93. PAGE B10

NATIONAL A12-21

Executive Order on A.I.

In a shift, President Trump asked tech companies to let the government vet their models before release. PAGE A16

Hegseth Blocks Promotions

The defense secretary's move appears to disproportionately target female and minority officers in the Navy. PAGE A17

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Braving World Cup Limbo

With their country at war with a co-host, Iran's soccer players are awaiting visas to the U.S., practicing in Turkey and making backup plans. PAGE B6

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Unvanishing ‘The Emporium’

A play by Thornton Wilder seemed to disappear without ever being staged. One man set out to find it. PAGE C1

Like Father, Like Son

The talk-show host Mark Consuelos and his son Joaquin tackle Broadway, just a few weeks, and blocks, apart. PAGE C1



BUSINESS B1-5

Bundles to Entice Subscribers

Entertainment outlets are teaming up, and viewers have shown an appetite for their streaming packages. PAGE B1

China’s Hunt for Nvidia Chips

A report suggests that the People's Liberation Army has tried to acquire restricted U.S. technology. PAGE B1

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Bernie Sanders

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